

no pAln app

Full guide

no pAln app — version 3.0

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This guide is the same one you find inside the app, under Guide.

Getting started

1 What no pAln app is and how it works

no pAln app lets you call for help in an instant. When you trigger the emergency — by saying the Siri phrase or pressing the big red button — the app alerts the people you chose (your "emergency contacts").

What your contacts receive

Depending on what you enable in settings, your contacts get: a Telegram message with your position on a map, your live position updated in real time, an SMS, a WhatsApp message, a phone call from you.

How the app can send SMS and calls

The app alone cannot send SMS or place calls: Apple forbids it. That is why it uses an Apple "Shortcut" called "Proteggimi". You install it ONCE with a button inside the app: this guide shows you how, step by step.

no pAln app does NOT replace official emergency services (112/911). In real danger, always call them too.

Keep this guide handy: reopen it any time by tapping the book symbol, top left on the main screen or at the top of Settings.

2 Free and Premium: what each includes

The app is free to download and the essential features are free forever. A few extra features unlock with a single purchase (no subscription).

Free for everyone

The red emergency button, the Telegram message with your position, 30-minute live location and the Apple Watch app.

With Premium (one-time purchase)

"Hey Siri" voice activation, SMS, WhatsApp message, automatic call, and a live location duration of your choice, from 1 minute to 24 hours.

How to unlock

- 1 Open Settings (gear at the top right).
- 2 Tap the orange "UNLOCK PREMIUM" button (or any feature with the  lock).
- 3 On the Premium screen tap "Unlock Premium" and confirm the purchase with your Apple ID.
- 4 Premium features appear in Settings immediately, no restart needed.

Did you buy the app back when it was paid? Premium is yours automatically, forever, at no extra cost. If it does not show as active, tap "Restore purchases" on the Premium screen.

New iPhone or reinstalled app? "Restore purchases" recovers your Premium from your Apple ID.

3 First launch: accepting the Terms

The first time you open the app you see the "Terms and Conditions" screen with a red notice at the top.

- 1** Scroll down and read the text: it explains what the app does and its limits (for example: without network coverage messages cannot go out).
- 2** At the bottom there is a switch next to "I HAVE READ AND ACCEPT THE TERMS AND CONDITIONS". Tap it: it turns green.
- 3** The "CONTINUE" button at the bottom, gray until now, becomes colored: tap it.

If the "CONTINUE" button stays gray it means you have not turned on the acceptance switch yet.

4 Permissions: what to grant and why

After the Terms you see the "Permissions" screen with three rows: Location, Notifications and Siri. Here is what each is for:

Location (required)

It tells your contacts WHERE you are during the emergency. Without it the app cannot work.

Notifications (optional)

They show you small helpful alerts, for example the reminder during the Shortcut installation.

Siri (optional)

It lets you trigger the emergency with your voice, without touching the phone.

What to do, step by step

- 1** Tap "CONTINUE". iOS will show you the requests one at a time.
- 2** Notifications request: tap "Allow".
- 3** Siri request: tap "Allow" (or "OK").
- 4** Location request: choose "Allow While Using the App". Shortly after (or in the following days) iOS will offer to switch to "Always": accept, because live location needs it when the phone is in your pocket.
- 5** When the "Location" row has a green check, the green "CONTINUE" button appears: tap it to move on to setup.

Which location option to choose (important)

When iOS asks for location it gives you three choices, and it matters which you pick:

- "Always": the best choice. It is the only one that lets live location work with the phone in your pocket or the screen off.
- "While Using the App": the emergency works with the app open, but live location stops as soon as you close the app. In that case the main screen shows a blue notice reminding you, with a tap to switch to "Always".
- "Allow Once": valid only for that time; when you reopen the app iOS removes the permission and location no longer works. In that case the main screen shows an orange "Location not active" notice.

Simple rule: if a location notice appears on the main screen (orange or blue), tap it — it takes you straight to Settings to choose "Always" and fix it in a moment.

If you denied location by mistake, an "Open Settings" button appears: tap it, choose Location → "Always" and come back to the app.

You can change permissions any time: iPhone Settings → search for "no pAln app".

Setting up the app

5 The Settings page: the full map

After permissions the configuration page opens (the same one you reopen later with the gear icon at the top right). It is long: you scroll down. Here are ALL its sections, in the order you meet them:

- 1 Guide — the book symbol at the top: opens this guide.
- 2  SIRI COMMAND LANGUAGE — choose the language of your voice command.
- 3  MANDATORY SHORTCUT — the blue button to install the Shortcut (essential).
- 4  SHORTCUT RESTORE — the orange button to reinstall it if it stops working.
- 5 TELEGRAM — the fields for Telegram contacts (Chat ID) and the test button.
- 6 EMERGENCY NUMBERS — the fields for phone numbers (SMS, WhatsApp, call).
- 7  SINGLE EMERGENCY NUMBER — the emergency services number (112 or your country's) for the call button on the main screen (free: see "The single emergency number (112)" in the "Using the app" chapter).
- 8 EMERGENCY ACTIONS — the switches to choose what fires during an emergency.
- 9  EMERGENCY BUTTON button4help — to connect the Bluetooth button that triggers the emergency even with the phone in your pocket (optional and free: see "The button4help emergency button" in the "Using the app" chapter).
- 10  INITIAL TEST — the orange "TEST THE APP" button for the full rehearsal.
- 11 SUMMARY — the recap with green checks for what you enabled.
- 12 SAVE — the final button that makes everything you typed effective.

Without Premium: instead of the language, Shortcut and numbers sections you will see a single "  PREMIUM FEATURES" section with the "UNLOCK PREMIUM" button, and the SMS/WhatsApp/call switches will show a lock. Everything else (Telegram, live location, test, save) is identical.

Your name (nickname)

At the top, below the guide, there is a "YOUR NAME" field: enter your name or a nickname (optional). It will be added at the start of emergency messages ("Message from ...") so your contacts immediately know who is asking for help, and it is also used in the message that tells them you stopped sharing your location.

The right order to configure

Follow the next pages of this guide in order: language → Shortcut → Telegram contact → numbers → actions → SAVE → test. You will be done in 10 minutes. (Without Premium: Telegram contact → actions → SAVE → test.)

What is saved and when. The TEXT FIELDS (your name, Chat IDs, phone numbers) take effect only after you tap SAVE at the bottom of the page; if you leave without saving, the app warns you with

"Unsaved changes". Everything else saves itself the moment you touch it: the switches, the live location duration, the command language, the button4help section and the single emergency number section (including a number typed by hand).

6 Section 🌐 SIRI COMMAND LANGUAGE

Premium feature: this section appears only with Premium active (the voice command is a Premium feature).

Here you choose the language you will speak the voice command in. The right language is the one you use with Siri.

- 1 Tap the "Language" row: the list of the 12 available languages opens.
- 2 Tap your language (for example "English").
- 3 Below, in green, the exact phrase to say appears: for English it is "Hey Siri, Protect me". Memorize it: it is what you will say in an emergency.

If you change the language AFTER installing the Shortcut, an orange warning appears: you must reinstall the Shortcut (button in the next section), because its name changes language too.

7 Section ⚠️ SHORTCUT: installation

Premium feature: the Shortcut only powers SMS, WhatsApp, the call and voice activation, which are Premium features. Without Premium this section does not appear and you do not need it: Telegram and live location work without it.

This is the most important step of the Premium setup. The "Proteggimi" Shortcut is the engine that sends SMS, WhatsApp and places the call: without it those actions cannot fire.

- 1 In the "⚠️ MANDATORY SHORTCUT" section tap the big blue "INSTALL SHORTCUT" button.
- 2 An iOS panel opens with the shortcut preview: tap "Add Shortcut".
- 3 ONLY IF YOU ALREADY HAVE IT: if you installed "Proteggimi" before, iOS asks what to do and offers three choices. Tap "Replace". The other two are wrong: "Keep Both" leaves you with two shortcuts with the same name and the app would not know which one to use, "Cancel" installs nothing.

Choosing "Replace" is safe: the new shortcut does everything the old one did, better and faster. You lose no settings, because numbers, contacts and preferences live inside the app, not inside the shortcut.

- 4 Apple's "Shortcuts" app opens and you will see the shortcut's actions. Do NOT touch any action: only tap "Done" at the top right.
- 5 If notifications are on, right then a notification reminds you exactly this: tap Done at the top right, then come back to noPainApp.

- 6 Return to the app: swipe up from the bottom (or press the Home button on iPhones that have one) and reopen the app.

Done: the Shortcut is installed. You will never have to redo this, unless you change language or edit it by mistake.

Do not open the shortcut in the Shortcuts app to explore or edit it: change even one action and it stops working.

If something goes wrong: the RESTORE section

Right below you find the " SHORTCUT RESTORE" section with an orange "RESTORE SHORTCUT" button: tap it and repeat steps 2–5 above. Use it whenever the shortcut seems missing, renamed or broken.

8 After every app update: redo the Shortcut

This is the easiest thing to forget, and the only one that can leave the app half-working at the wrong moment. Read it once and remember it.

When the app updates, the Shortcut on your phone does NOT update by itself. iOS does not let any app install or change a shortcut without you confirming it: so the old one stays, and it keeps working but without the improvements of the new version.

What to do, every time you update the app

- 1 Open the app Settings (gear) and scroll down to " SHORTCUT RESTORE".
- 2 Tap "RESTORE SHORTCUT".
- 3 When iOS asks what to do with the shortcut you already have, choose "Replace". Not "Keep Both": you would end up with two shortcuts with the same name and the app would not know which one to use.
- 4 Tap "Done" at the top right and go back to the app.

If in Settings you see an orange warning saying the Shortcut may be an outdated version, this is exactly the moment to redo it.

Then ALWAYS run the test, with every option switched on

After reinstalling the shortcut, go to the " INITIAL TEST" section and run a test. Before you do, switch ON every option you will actually use: Telegram, live location, SMS, WhatsApp, calls.

Here is why this matters: the first time the shortcut performs an action, iOS asks for permission — "allow sending messages?", "allow calls?". If the test does not take those questions, the real emergency will: and at that moment nobody is there to tap "Allow", because you are the one asking for help.

Run the test with a contact who knows about it, and remember the call really goes through: use a harmless number, never the emergency number.

It also applies when you change language

Changing the language in the  section means switching to a shortcut with a different name ("Protect me", "Protège-moi"...). ALWAYS reinstall it after the change, even if it seems to work already: if an old shortcut with that name was still on the phone, the app would open that one. Afterwards, delete from the Shortcuts app the ones in languages you no longer use.

9 TELEGRAM section: getting the Chat ID (automatic)

Telegram is the most reliable channel: it fires by itself even with the phone locked in your pocket. To use it, the app needs to know WHO to write to: every person on Telegram has a personal number called "Chat ID". You do not need to understand it — you only need it to appear in the field, and the app has an automatic system that does everything.

Before you start

The person you want to alert (say, your son or your sister) must have Telegram installed on THEIR phone. If you can be on a call together during these steps, everything is easier.

The steps, one by one

- 1 In the "TELEGRAM" section, under the "Telegram Chat ID 1" field, tap "Get Chat ID automatically".
- 2 The text "Share the link with the recipient" appears and a 60-second countdown starts: "Waiting... (60s)".
- 3 Tap the blue "Share link" button and choose how to send the link to the person: WhatsApp, SMS, Telegram... whatever you normally use.
- 4 NOW IT IS THEIR TURN: on their phone they must open the received link. Telegram opens on the app's bot page: they must tap the "START" button at the bottom.
- 5 As soon as they do, on YOUR phone "✅ Chat ID acquired!" appears and the number fills the "Telegram Chat ID 1" field by itself. Done!
- 6 If time runs out you see "⌚ Timeout — try again": no problem. Get on a call together, tap "Get Chat ID automatically" again and this time they open the link right away.

Second contact (optional)

You can alert up to two people on Telegram: repeat the same steps with "Get Chat ID 2 automatically" under the "Telegram Chat ID 2 (optional)" field.

To stop an ongoing search tap the small "Cancel search" text.

10 Chat ID by hand (alternative method)

If the automatic method really does not work, there is a manual path. It needs one extra step — take it slowly.

- 1 The person to alert opens Telegram on their phone and types in the search bar: @userinfobot

- 2 They open that contact and tap "START": the bot immediately replies with their data, including an "Id" line followed by a number (for example Id: 123456789).
- 3 They send you that number (for example by SMS).
- 4 You type it into the "Telegram Chat ID 1" field (just the number, no spaces).

Essential extra step: the person must also open the app's bot and press "START", otherwise Telegram will not let the bot message them. The automatic method does this by itself; with the manual method, ask them to open the link you share via "Get Chat ID automatically" and press START — or simply use the automatic method.

11 Trying Telegram: "Test Telegram"

As soon as the "Telegram Chat ID 1" field is filled, verify right away that it works.

- 1 In the TELEGRAM section tap "Test Telegram". The button shows "Sending..." for a few seconds.
- 2 If all is well, "✅ Test Successful" appears and your contact receives a test message on Telegram starting with "📞 TEST from no pAln app".
- 3 Ask your contact to confirm the message really arrived.

If "❌ Test Failed" appears with "Invalid Chat ID": the number in the field is wrong, or the person never pressed START on the bot. Redo "Get Chat ID automatically" from the start.

12 EMERGENCY NUMBERS section

Premium feature: this section appears only with Premium active (SMS, WhatsApp and the call are Premium features).

Here you enter the phone numbers for SMS, WhatsApp and the call (Telegram does NOT use these numbers: it uses the Chat IDs from the previous section).

- 1 Tap the "Number 1 (e.g. +393331234567)" field and type the number with the keypad.
- 2 The format is crucial: first the international prefix (+44 for the UK, +1 for the US, +39 for Italy...), then the number, all together with no spaces. Correct example: +447911123456. Wrong examples: 07911123456 (missing prefix), +44 7911 123456 (has spaces).
- 3 If you want, add a second number in the "Number 2 (optional)" field.

If the contact is abroad, use their country's prefix.

13 EMERGENCY ACTIONS section: the switches

Here you decide what happens when you trigger the emergency. Each row is a switch: green/on = that action will fire.

Send Telegram

Sends the message with your position to the Chat IDs you entered. It can only be turned on if there is at least one Chat ID: if it is gray and will not move, go back to the TELEGRAM section.

Live location (Telegram)

Appears only if "Send Telegram" is on. Besides the message, it sends your LIVE position: your contacts watch you move on the map. Highly recommended. On the free version it lasts 30 minutes; with Premium a "Live location duration" row appears below the switch, where you pick the duration: from 1 minute up to 24 hours (30 minutes if you never change it).

Under this switch an orange warning about the "Always" Location permission may appear: it means you must go to iPhone Settings → no pAI n app → Location → choose "Always", otherwise the live feed stops when the screen turns off.

Long durations (hours) use more battery: pick what suits your habits — you can change it any time.

Send SMS / Send WhatsApp / Make call (Premium)

They use the numbers from the EMERGENCY NUMBERS section. They only turn on if there is at least one number. There is only one call. If you entered two numbers, the "The call goes to" option appears under "Make a call": choose Number 1 or Number 2 (Number 1 at first). If the chosen number is missing or not valid, the shortcut calls the other one. SMS and WhatsApp messages go to both numbers instead. Without Premium these rows show a lock: tap them to open the unlock screen.

Tip: keep Telegram always on. It is the only channel that fires by itself even with the phone locked; SMS, WhatsApp and the call need the phone in hand and unlocked.

14 Saving: the SAVE button

A very short but ESSENTIAL step: without saving, the numbers and Chat IDs you typed are worth nothing.

- 1 Scroll to the very bottom of the page.
- 2 Check the "SUMMARY" section: next to Telegram, SMS, WhatsApp and Call you see a green check if that channel is ready (enabled AND with its contact entered).
- 3 Tap "SAVE" (on first launch it is called "SAVE AND CONTINUE").
- 4 The alert "Settings Saved" — "Your settings have been saved." appears: tap "OK".

If the SAVE button is gray and below it you read a warning about entering at least one Chat ID or number, all the contact fields are empty: enter at least one contact.

From now on, whenever you change a text field (name, Chat IDs, numbers), remember to tap SAVE again. If you forget, leaving the page shows the "Unsaved changes" alert with three choices: "Save and close", "Close without saving" and "Cancel". Switches and pickers save themselves.

15 Section INITIAL TEST: the full rehearsal

Last setup step: a complete rehearsal, identical to a real emergency. It also has a technical purpose: on its FIRST run, iOS asks the Shortcut for a series of permissions — better to grant them now, calmly, than during a real emergency.

- 1 WARN YOUR CONTACTS FIRST that you are about to run a test, so they do not panic.
- 2 In the " INITIAL TEST" section tap the orange "TEST THE APP" button.
- 3 The alert " Warning — This will send a REAL emergency message to the configured contacts. Continue?" appears: tap "Run Test".
- 4 The Shortcuts app opens and runs "Proteggimi". The first time a few requests will appear, for example permission to send messages or to contact api.telegram.org: always tap "Allow" (when offered, choose "Always Allow" so it stops asking).
- 5 If SMS is enabled, Messages opens with the text ready: tap the arrow to send. If WhatsApp is enabled, WhatsApp opens: send. If the call is enabled, a single call is placed, to the number chosen in the "The call goes to" option (if you have only one number, to that one).
- 6 At the end you return to the app automatically.
- 7 Verify with your contacts: did the Telegram with the map arrive? Is the live position moving? SMS/WhatsApp received? Did the call come through?

After this first test, later runs go smoothly with far fewer prompts. Repeat the test now and then (say, once a month) to be sure everything still works.

After EVERY app update, repeat the test: on the first run after an update, iOS may ask the Shortcut for a permission again. The app reminds you by itself: after tapping SAVE on a never-tested version, it offers the test with an alert ("Run test" / "Later").

Using the app

16 Emergency by touch: the red button

- 1 Open no pAI app: you are on the main screen.
- 2 Press the big red  "EMERGENCY — HELP REQUEST" button.
- 3 The status text above the button becomes  "Starting emergency...": Telegram and live location fire IMMEDIATELY, automatically.
- 4 For a few moments the Shortcuts app opens and runs SMS, WhatsApp and the call (the ones you enabled), then you come back to the app.
- 5 After a few seconds the status returns to "Ready".

If you see a warning asking to install the "Proteggimi" Shortcut, the shortcut is missing: go to Settings (gear) →  SHORTCUT RESTORE section.

17 Emergency by voice: the Siri phrase

Premium feature: voice activation requires Premium and the installed Shortcut.

The fastest way — it works even with the screen locked and the phone in your bag.

- 1 Say out loud the phrase shown in green on the main screen (for English: "Hey Siri, Protect me").
- 2 The very first time Siri may ask you to confirm running the shortcut: answer "Yes" (or tap "Run").
- 3 From then on everything proceeds as with the red button: Telegram and location fire right away, then the other actions.

If Siri says it cannot find the shortcut: check that the Shortcut is installed and that the chosen language matches the one you speak to Siri ( SIRI COMMAND LANGUAGE section).

Try the phrase with Siri at least once during the initial test, so you catch any hiccup early.

18 Other quick ways: Back Tap, Action button, a phrase without "Hey Siri"

Premium feature: these ways start the Shortcut, so they require Premium and the installed Shortcut.

Besides the red button and "Hey Siri", iPhone lets you start the emergency Shortcut in other ways, chosen in the iPhone Settings. You do not need to open no pAI app: everything runs as with "Hey Siri". The shortcut name is the one shown in green on the main screen (in English "Protect me").

Tapping the back of the iPhone

Tap the back of the phone two or three times with a finger, even through the case. Available from iPhone 8 onwards.

- 1 Open iPhone Settings → Accessibility → Touch → Back Tap.
- 2 Choose "Triple Tap" (recommended: harder to do by accident) or "Double Tap".
- 3 Scroll the list to the shortcuts section and tap "Protect me" (or the name in your language).
- 4 To start the emergency, tap the back of the iPhone three (or two) times.

Action button

The button on the left side, above the volume buttons, on iPhone 15 Pro, iPhone 15 Pro Max and the later models that have it.

- 1 Open iPhone Settings → Action Button.
- 2 Swipe through the icons to "Shortcut".
- 3 Tap the button that appears below the label and choose "Protect me" (or the name in your language). If you do not choose the shortcut, the button does nothing.
- 4 To start the emergency, press and hold the Action button.

Icon on the Home Screen

The closest thing to an emergency button always at hand: an icon that runs the shortcut with one tap, without opening no pAI n app. It needs the phone unlocked, but it works even if no pAI n has been fully closed (checked on an iPhone XR).

- 1 Open the Shortcuts app (Apple's own).
- 2 Press and hold the "Protect me" shortcut (or the name in your language), then tap "Details" or the three-dot icon.
- 3 Tap "Add to Home Screen", choose the name shown under the icon, then "Add".
- 4 To start the emergency, tap the icon.

You can place it on the first screen, next to no pAI n app, so you always find it.

Shortcuts widget

Same idea, but bigger and easier to hit in a hurry.

- 1 On the Home Screen, press and hold an empty spot until the icons jiggle, then tap "+" at the top.
- 2 Search for "Shortcuts", choose the widget size and tap "Add Widget".
- 3 Press and hold the widget → "Edit Widget" → choose "Protect me".
- 4 To start the emergency, tap the widget.

Control in Control Center and on the Lock Screen

From iOS 18 you can add a button that runs the shortcut among the system controls, even in place of the flashlight on the Lock Screen.

- 1 Open Control Center (swipe down from the top-right corner), tap "+" at the top left, then "Add a Control".

- 2 Search for "Shortcut" in the gallery, tap it and choose "Protect me".
- 3 To add it to the Lock Screen too: press the side button, press and hold the Lock Screen (unlock with Face ID or passcode if asked, then press and hold again), tap "Customize" and then the Lock Screen panel. Tap "-" on the flashlight control to remove it, then "+" in its place, choose "Shortcut" and then "Protect me". Tap "Done".

Checked on an iPhone XR with iOS 18: from the Lock Screen the iPhone asks for the passcode or Face ID FIRST, and only then runs the shortcut. So the control is handy with the phone unlocked, but with the phone locked it saves no time: there the button4help, the Apple Watch or your voice are the way. On newer models, try again: the behaviour may differ.

Your own phrase, without "Hey Siri" (Vocal Shortcuts)

From iOS 18 you can teach the iPhone a phrase of your choice that starts the shortcut, without saying "Hey Siri" first.

- 1 Open iPhone Settings → Accessibility → Vocal Shortcuts.
- 2 Tap "Set Up" (or "Add Action" if you already have one), then "Continue".
- 3 As the action choose "Siri Request" and type the shortcut name: "Protect me" (or the name in your language).
- 4 Type the phrase you want to say, then repeat it out loud when the iPhone asks, so it learns to recognise it.
- 5 To start the emergency, say your phrase.

Choose a phrase of two or three words you never use in normal conversation: every time the iPhone recognises it, a REAL emergency starts.

While Vocal Shortcuts is on, an icon appears at the top of the screen: it means the iPhone is listening with the microphone to recognise the phrase. The audio is processed on the phone.

After setting up one of these ways, run a real test, warning your contacts first: with the phone unlocked, with the screen locked and after fully closing no pAI. This way you know in advance how your iPhone behaves.

19 Summary: what fires, with which trigger and in which conditions

The channels are not all the same. Telegram and the live location are sent by the app itself, even with the screen off. SMS, WhatsApp and the phone call are performed by the Shortcut, which iPhone runs only when the emergency starts from your touch or your voice on the phone, with no pAI in the foreground.

The rule in one sentence: what counts is the state of the app at that moment, not where the trigger comes from. If no pAI is open in the foreground everything fires; if it is in the background or the screen is locked, ONLY Telegram and the location are sent; if it has been fully closed, neither the button nor the Apple Watch wakes it.

Red button in the app

✅ Telegram, live location, SMS, WhatsApp, phone call: everything fires. It is the complete way.

button4help button

✅ App open and in the foreground: everything fires.

✅ Screen off, phone in your pocket or app in the background: Telegram and the live location are sent.

❌ Screen off or app in the background: SMS, WhatsApp and the call do NOT fire.

❌ App fully closed (swiped away from the list of open apps): nothing fires until you open the app again.

Apple Watch

✅ App open and in the foreground on the iPhone: everything fires, Shortcut included (checked).

✅ iPhone locked or app in the background: Telegram and the live location are sent.

❌ iPhone locked or app in the background: SMS, WhatsApp and the call do NOT fire.

Home Screen icon and Shortcuts widget

✅ Everything fires, even if no pAI had been fully closed.

❌ They cannot be used with the phone locked: the Home Screen requires unlocking.

Control in Control Center or on the Lock Screen

✅ With the phone unlocked: everything fires.

❌ With the phone locked the iPhone asks for the passcode or Face ID first (checked on an iPhone XR with iOS 18): it saves no time.

Tapping the back of the iPhone

✅ When your model performs it, everything fires as from the icon.

❌ It does not work with Low Power Mode on, and on some older models it does not fire at all (on our test iPhone XR it did not).

"Hey Siri, Protect me" and your own phrase (Vocal Shortcuts)

✅ They start the Shortcut, so in normal conditions everything fires, even with the app fully closed.

❌ On our test iPhone XR the personal phrase is not recognised with the screen off, and Siri did not activate by voice because of a problem of that phone, not of the app.

On other models and iOS versions these behaviours may change: always test YOUR phone, with your contacts warned, before relying on it.

How to make the most of it: when you go out, keep no pAI open in the background (just go back to the Home Screen, do not swipe it away) and the button paired. That way the button always sends Telegram and the location, and if the phone is in your hand you can complete with the red button.

20 What your contacts receive and should do

On Telegram

A message arrives starting with "Help, this is an emergency! I'm in serious danger!" followed by a map link with your position, the address and the coordinates. Tapping the link opens the map. If live location is enabled, your live position also appears below.

If the first message lacks the street or the house number, a few seconds later a second message "  Precise address: ..." may arrive by itself with street and number, when they can be found. The first send is never delayed because of this.

Addresses come from Apple's location services and, when needed, from © OpenStreetMap contributors data (Nominatim and Overpass API services).

On SMS and WhatsApp

A message arrives from YOUR number with your name, the help request, the address and the map link: the same information as the Telegram message. The SMS text is shorter, because it fits in a single message and does not cost like two.

The call

One of your contacts receives a phone call from you: a single call is placed, to the number chosen in settings under "The call goes to" (if you have only one number, to that one). Even if you cannot speak, the contact understands something is wrong and sees your position on the other channels.

Explain TODAY to your contacts what to do if they get the alert: try calling you back immediately and, if you do not answer, call the emergency services reporting the position they see on the map.

21 Live location

If the "Live location (Telegram)" switch is on, after the emergency your contacts see a pin on the Telegram map moving with you. It then stops by itself when the duration expires: 30 minutes on the free version, while with Premium you choose the duration in Settings (from 1 minute to 24 hours).

While the live feed is active, you see the blue location indicator at the top of your iPhone screen: that is normal — it means it is working.

Stop sharing whenever you want

You do not have to wait for it to expire: while the live feed is active, a "Stop sharing location" button appears on the main screen. Tap it when the emergency is over or you are safe and no longer want to share where you are: the app asks Telegram to end the live feed. If the phone has no connection, the request goes out as soon as it comes back, so for a few minutes your contacts may still see the last position.

When you tap "Stop sharing", your contacts also receive a Telegram message telling them that you stopped it (with your name, if you set one): so they know the live feed ended because you chose to end it, not because the phone ran out of battery. Note: stopping the sharing does not tell your contacts that you are safe. If it matters, message or call them yourself.

Explain this to whoever is helping you: how to read "updated 3 minutes ago"

Under the pin, Telegram shows when the last location update arrived: "now", "1 minute ago", "3 minutes ago". That time grows older whenever no new position arrives, and there can be different reasons.

- 1 The person is standing still, or is somewhere the GPS cannot reach: garage, basement, lift, tunnel. The position does not change and there is nothing to update. This is the most common case, and as soon as the person moves outdoors the time goes back to "now".
- 2 The phone has switched off, run out of battery, lost the network, or the app was closed. Careful: in this case too the map stays visible as "live" until it expires, exactly as in case 1. A map that is still live does not prove that the phone is updating.

Looking at the map alone, the two cases cannot be told apart. So the advice is simple: if the time stays frozen for more than a few minutes, do not wait, try calling.

- 3 A message arrives saying sharing was stopped: it is over, and the person stopped it.

If sharing ends with no message at all, the planned time may simply have expired, or something may have happened to the phone. Here too, if in doubt, call.

If contacts say the pin does not move: almost always the Location permission is not set to "Always". Go to iPhone Settings → no pAI n app → Location → "Always", then run a test again.

22 From the Apple Watch

If you have a paired Apple Watch, the app appears on the watch too.

- 1 Open no pAI n on the Watch: there is a big red "EMERGENCY" button.
- 2 Press it: "✅ Sent" appears below (it disappears by itself after about ten seconds).
- 3 If at that moment the watch cannot reach the iPhone, "📶 Queued" appears: the emergency will fire by itself as soon as they reconnect.

What fires from the Watch

Telegram and the position (live too) ALWAYS fire, even with the iPhone locked in your pocket. SMS, WhatsApp and the call instead fire only if, at that moment, the no pAI n app on the iPhone is open and in the foreground: this is an Apple limitation, not a defect.

If SMS or the call matter most to you, use the Watch as a shortcut when the iPhone app is open, and otherwise trigger the emergency with Siri or from the phone.

23 The button4help emergency button

button4help is a small Bluetooth button to keep with you (in your pocket, around your neck, on your wrist). Holding it pressed for a few seconds triggers the emergency without touching the phone: even with the screen off, the phone in your bag and the app in the background. It is a free feature.

The button is OFF by default. If you do not have a button4help, leave it that way: the app works exactly as always. If you do have one, it must be turned on and paired once, following the steps below: until you do, pressing it does nothing.

Where to get it

button4help is not sold inside the app. To find out where to get it, open Settings (gear), go to the "🔵 EMERGENCY BUTTON button4help" section and tap "Where to get the button4help button": the button page on the no pAI website opens (eledigilab.github.io/no-pain-site/button4help.html).

Before buying it, read the compatibility notes for your phone on that page.

Turning it on (only once)

- 1 Open the app Settings (gear) and scroll to the "🔵 EMERGENCY BUTTON button4help" section.
- 2 Turn on the "Enable the button" switch. The status shows "Not paired".
- 3 Tap "Pair the button". The first time, iOS asks for permission to use Bluetooth: tap "Allow".
- 4 Rest the button on your phone and hold it pressed. When the status changes to "Connecting..." you can release it.
- 5 After a moment the dot turns green and the status says "Ready": the button is active.

The two buttons: which one to use

Below the status there are two buttons, and under each one it says what it is for. "Pair the button" is the normal way: it works for the button4help and for every model the app already recognises, even a brand new one. "New or unrecognised button" is only for a button from another maker, or if the normal pairing does not work.

In both cases the procedure starts by tapping the button on screen: resting the button on the phone on its own does nothing.

In that case, tap "New or unrecognised button", then rest the button on your phone and follow the on-screen instructions: press, hold for a couple of seconds and release, 3 times; then press once more to confirm. The app learns by itself how your button works, with nothing technical for you to know.

Using it in an emergency

Hold the button pressed for the time shown by the "Sensitivity" you chose: 2 seconds (High, the default), 3 seconds (Medium) or 4 seconds (Low). Calmly count "one, two" (or up to three, or four), then release. A shorter press is ignored: this protects you from accidental presses in your pocket.

Telegram and your position (live too, if enabled) fire immediately. SMS, WhatsApp and the call instead fire only if, at that moment, the app is open and in the foreground: this is an Apple limitation, the same as for the Apple Watch.

The Location permission must be set to "Always" (iPhone Settings → no pAI app → Location → "Always"). Otherwise, with the app closed, the message is sent but WITHOUT your position. If the

permission is wrong, the button section warns you with an orange notice.

Do not fully close the app, that is, do not open the list of open apps to swipe it away upwards: iOS then stops waking it when you press the button, until you open it again. Going back to the Home Screen, locking the phone or turning the screen off is perfectly fine: the button keeps working. Every time you pair a button the app reminds you with a notice, and the button section always shows it in orange.

Understanding the status

Green dot "Ready": all good. Orange dot "Connecting...": the button is far away or off; it reconnects by itself as soon as it is back in range, you do not need to do anything. "Bluetooth off": turn Bluetooth back on — without it the button cannot work. Red dot "Unreachable": bring the button closer; if it stays like that, tap "Unpair the button" and pair it again.

With the page open you also see a "Signal" row: if it says "Weak", the button is at the edge of its range — keep it closer to the phone. The "Button battery" row, when present, shows the charge read when the button was paired: if it is red, the charge is low.

Run a real test as soon as it is set up (warn your contacts first) and repeat it now and then.

"Unpair the button" disconnects it from this phone, for example to replace it. Turning off the "Enable the button" switch stops the button completely.

24 The single emergency number (112)

Below the red button on the main screen there is the "Single emergency number" button: until you enable it, it is gray and does nothing. Once enabled it becomes "📞 Call 112" (or your country's emergency number) and lets you call emergency services directly. It is a free feature.

Enabling it

- 1 Open Settings (gear) and scroll to the "📞 SINGLE EMERGENCY NUMBER" section.
- 2 Turn on "Enable the button on the main screen": the emergency number of the region set on your iPhone fills in by itself (112 in almost all of Europe, 999 in the United Kingdom, 911 in the United States and Canada).
- 3 Check the country: if it is not the right one, tap "Country" and choose yours. If your country is not listed, choose "📍 Other" and type the number by hand. Everything saves itself, no need to tap SAVE.
- 4 Go back to the main screen: the button is now white with a red border and reads "📞 Call 112".

The button stays gray if the number is missing or invalid (the section tells you in orange) or if the device cannot make phone calls, for example a Wi-Fi-only iPad.

Using it

- 1 Tap "📞 Call 112".

2 The question "Call emergency services?" appears: tap "Call". With emergency numbers the call starts immediately, with no further confirmation. If you tapped by mistake, tap "Cancel".

This number is NOT part of the automatic emergency: it receives no messages and is never called by itself — not by the red button, nor Siri, nor the Apple Watch, nor the button4help button. It is a call you make yourself, when needed.

If you want to do both, red button first. With Premium, let the Shortcut finish its work (SMS, WhatsApp and the call to your contacts) and bring you back to the app, then call 112: calling while the Shortcut is still working would interrupt it.

Use this button only in a real emergency: an unjustified call to emergency services may be an offence. NEVER try it with 112: for a test choose " Other", enter a family member's number for a few minutes, then set your country back.

If something goes wrong

25 Common problems and solutions

The red button warns about installing the Shortcut

The Shortcut is missing or was renamed. Settings (gear) → "🔄 SHORTCUT RESTORE" → orange button → "Add Shortcut" → "Done".

"Test Telegram" gives ❌ Test Failed

The Chat ID is wrong or the contact never pressed START on the bot. Redo "Get Chat ID automatically" with the person on the phone.

The Chat ID search always ends in "⌚ Timeout"

The 60 seconds run out before the person opens the link. Get on a call: you tap "Get Chat ID automatically" and "Share link", they open the link and press START right away.

Live location does not update

Location permission not set to "Always". iPhone Settings → no pAIIn app → Location → "Always".

Siri does not understand or cannot find the shortcut

Check: 1) the Shortcut is installed; 2) the language chosen in the 🌐 section matches the one you speak to Siri; 3) Siri is enabled in iPhone Settings.

"Hey Siri, Protect me" no longer starts anything

Check in this order: 1) open the Shortcuts app and run "Protect me" with a tap: if that works, only voice starting is affected; 2) make sure there is ONE shortcut with that exact name (no "1", "2" or copies); 3) iPhone Settings → Siri: "Listen for Hey Siri" on, and Siri's language the same as the shortcut name's language; 4) iPhone Settings → Face ID & Passcode → "Siri" on, otherwise Siri runs nothing while the phone is locked; 5) try saying "Hey Siri, run Protect me"; 6) turn the iPhone off and on again: after an update or a reinstall of the shortcut, iOS sometimes needs to rebuild its list of shortcuts.

An ACTIONS switch is gray and will not turn on

It is missing the data it needs: a Chat ID for Telegram, a number for SMS/WhatsApp/call. Enter the contact and try again.

I changed the command language

Reinstall the Shortcut (🔄 section), because its name changed along with the language.

The contact receives nothing

Make sure you tapped SAVE after entering the contacts, and that the SUMMARY shows green checks. Then run the test again.

I cannot see the language, Shortcut or numbers sections

They are Premium features: in Settings you see the "🔒 PREMIUM FEATURES" section in their place. Tap "UNLOCK PREMIUM" to buy them, or "Restore purchases" if you already bought the app or Premium.

I bought Premium but it still shows as locked

Open the Premium screen (from any lock) and tap "Restore purchases" with the same Apple ID used for the purchase.

Golden rule: after changing your name, Chat IDs or numbers tap SAVE; after ANY change, run a test.